



United States Department of Justice Civil Rights Division

civilrights.justice.gov

Thank you for submitting a
report to the Civil Rights
Division.

Report successfully submitted



Your record number is:

625086-KKV

Save report

What to expect

① We review your report

Our specialists in the Civil Rights Division carefully read every report to identify civil rights violations, spot trends, and determine if we have authority to help with your report.

② Our specialists determine the next step

We may decide to:

Open an investigation or take some other action within the legal authority of the Justice Department.

Collect more information before we can look into your report.

Recommend another government agency that can properly look into your report. If so, we'll let you know.

In some cases, we may determine that we don't have legal authority to handle your report and

will recommend that you seek help from a private lawyer or local legal aid organization.

③ When possible, we will follow up with you

We do our best to let you know about the outcome of our review. However, we may not always be able to provide you with updates because:

We're actively working on an investigation or case related your report.

We're receiving and actively reviewing many requests at the same time.

If we are able to respond, we will contact you using the contact information you provided in this report. Depending on the type of report, response times can vary. If you need to reach us about your report, please refer to your report number when contacting us. This is how we keep track of your submission.

What you can do next

① **Contact local legal aid organizations or a lawyer if you haven't already**

Legal aid offices or members of lawyer associations in your state may be able to help you with your issue.

Legal Services Corporation (or Legal Aid Offices), to help you find a legal aid lawyer in your area visit

www.lsc.gov/find-legal-aid

② **Get help immediately if you are in danger**

If you reported an incident where you or someone else has experienced or is still experiencing physical harm or violence, or are in immediate danger, please call 911 and contact the police.

Your submission

Contact

Contact information

Your name

Austin Underwood

Email address

cosmicindustries@protonmail.com

Phone number

+19122699283

Address

362 Strickland Road

-

Brunswick, Georgia 31523

Are you now or have ever been an active duty service member?

No

Primary concern

What is your primary reason for contacting the Civil Rights Division?

Mistreated by police, correctional staff, or inmates

Location

Did this happen while in custody or incarcerated?

No

Where did this happen?

Organization name

Jekyll Island Toll Booth Exit

Address

Ocean Highway / Jekyll Island Road

US 17;GA 25;GA 520 18/31.059126/-81.446704

Jekyll Island, Georgia

Personal characteristics

Do you believe any of these personal characteristics influenced why you were treated this way?

Family, marital, or parental status
Other reason

Date

When did this happen?

5/21/2023

Personal description

In your own words, describe what happened

Subject: Unlawful Arrest and Assault – May 21, 2023

Location: Thompson Bridge Exit (31.060498, -81.449246), Glynn County, GA

Involved Officers: Unidentified GSP Officer (primary), Officer Edwards (backup)

I, Austin Tyler Underwood, submit this formal statement regarding the events of May 21, 2023, at approximately 5:50 PM. This testimony reflects my direct experience, supported by documented trauma and subsequent disability.

Incident Overview:

While returning from work on Jekyll Island, I was exiting Thompson Bridge toward the mainland when a Georgia State Patrol SUV passed heading toward the bridge, then abruptly turned around and began following me with lights off. Shortly after, the officer activated blue lights, and I slowed to yield. Instead of stopping me, the officer passed and pulled over another car ahead.

Believing it safe, I passed both vehicles in the opposite lane — traffic was clear — and continued. The officer then re-engaged his lights and ordered me to pull over. I complied, asking why, but received no explanation. He then aggressively used his vehicle to push mine off the road — not into oncoming traffic, but into the grass shoulder. The officer himself had entered the

oncoming traffic lane to position his SUV for this maneuver.

Physical Assault and Arrest:

I exited my vehicle and followed commands, though the officer gave no reason for the stop. I was ordered to the rear of my car and, upon complying, was pushed forcefully against it and then against his SUV. I asked repeatedly why I was being detained. No response was given. I was then thrown to the ground, one shoe knocked off, and left in an anthill while being handcuffed. I never resisted; I only asked for justification. The officer eventually claimed "obstruction."

Officer Edwards Arrives:

Officer Edwards arrived as backup. I informed him of the excessive force used and noted the primary officer had tape covering his body cam. Officer Edwards' camera appeared active (blinking). My vehicle was still running, and I requested my parents retrieve it. They initially refused, but I was later allowed to call my father. The officers searched my vehicle without my consent or a warrant.

Transport and Processing:

During transport, the primary officer drove erratically and veered off the road multiple times. I commented on his distracted driving. At the jail, I was asked about my mental state and whether I had issues with police. I explained I

was simply exhausted and in pain. I was processed and held in a cell with violent offenders, despite facing a non-violent charge. I was eventually bonded out.

Ongoing Harm:

I suffer from chronic back pain, require a cane to walk, and continue to experience symptoms of PTSD, including memory suppression. I am unable to recall the name of the primary officer due to trauma. I seek official records to identify him.

Statement:

This account is accurate to the best of my recollection. I am prepared to testify, submit records, and cooperate in all lawful investigations.

I am submitting additional supporting documentation related to a civil rights complaint filed against the Georgia State Patrol and judicial actors in Glynn County, Georgia.

These documents include a formal motion to strike a procedural filing that was unsigned, served with coercive timing, and used as retaliation following a delayed prosecution.

I respectfully request this be reviewed under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 and included in the investigative timeline.